

Producer through-line — what happens today

Retrack This · as of Sept 21, 2026 · charge-upfront Checkout live
Editable working doc for founder / Damian meetings and the community update email.
Yellow boxes = open product questions / gaps to discuss.

One-sentence version. Producer fills out a gig → pays up front at checkout → musicians submit until the deadline → producer favorites takes (no early close) → after the deadline they have 48 hours to award a musician. No award in time with a favorite → we auto-award it. No favorite → refund.

1. Status pills (what the producer sees)

Pill	Code status	Meaning
Draft	PENDING_PAYMENT	Saved gig, not paid yet. Private. Can edit, finish payment, or discard.
Open	OPEN	Paid and live. Musicians can submit. Producer can edit refs/title (not price), cancel+refund, pick takes.
Paying	AWARDING	Payout in progress (brief). Retry if stuck.
Awarded	AWARDED	Winner paid (or marked for manual PayPal/Wise). Masters unlock.
Cancelled	CANCELLED	Closed with no award. If money was taken → refunded. Unpaid discard can be restored as Draft.

2. Happy path (decision tree)

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START: Producer clicks "Post a job"
├─ Fill form (title, refs, instrument, price, deadline 1–7 days, optional invite)
├─ "Post job & pay" → creates Draft job + Stripe Embedded Checkout on the page
│   ├── Pay succeeds
│   │   ├── → webhook checkout.session.completed (or confirm-checkout fallback)
│   │   ├── → Job = Open, payment = captured
│   │   └── → emails: matching musicians + optional invite
│   ├── "Save as draft" / close checkout without paying
│   │   └── → stays Draft (private). Finish payment later.
│   └── "Discard draft"
│       └── → Cancelled (no charge). Can Restore as draft if never paid.
└─ While Open (until deadline – cannot close early):
    └─ Musicians submit takes (free; need payouts set up)
        ├── Producer "Favorite this submission"
        │   └── → private favorite; job stays Open; can switch favorites
        ├── Producer "Cancel & refund"
        │   └── → refund Stripe charge → Cancelled; musicians notified
        └─ Deadline hits → submissions close → email: "48 hours to award"
            ├── Producer "Award this submission"
            │   └── → claim AWARDING → transfer → Awarded → masters unlock
            ├── Has favorite, 48h passes with no click?
            │   └── → cron auto-awards that favorite
            └─ No favorite, 48h passes?
                └── → cron Cancel & refund
```

3. What gets “pinged” (systems)

Moment	Who / what
Post & pay	Our API → Stripe Checkout → Stripe webhook → DB Open → Resend emails (new job / invites)
Submit take	Musician API → storage upload → email producer (if prefs on)
End gig & pay	API claims job → Stripe transfer (Connect) or admin manual queue → emails winner
Cancel / refund	API → Stripe refund (or expire unpaid session) → email musicians
Daily cron (~noon MT)	Auto-finalize due picks · auto-refund no-winner past grace · 3-day-left reminders

4. Branch: cancel / refund / discard

Discard draft (never paid). No Stripe charge. Job Cancelled. Producer can *Restore as draft* and try again. Nothing emailed to musicians (job was never public).

Cancel open job (already paid). Full refund via Stripe. Job Cancelled. Musicians who submitted get a cancelled email. Takes stay in DB but job is closed.

Product cost note. Stripe keeps ~2.9%+\$0.30 on refunds. Founders still need a written cancel/refund policy for the community email.

5. Branch: deadline with / without a favorite

- **Deadline hits:** Submissions close. Producer gets “48 hours to award” email.
- **Favorite saved:** Producer can award (or switch) within 48h. Cron auto-awards the favorite if they don’t.
- **No favorite:** Same 48h to pick someone. Then cron refunds and cancels.
- **No early “End gig & pay”.** Jobs stay open for the full deadline so musicians get an accurate window.
- **Cron is daily** on Hobby — the 48h cleanup may wait until the next daily run. Award clicks are instant.

6. Branch: award / payout

- Musician must have Stripe Connect ready *or* PayPal/Wise on file.
- Platform fee ~10%; rest transfers to musician.
- Alt payout → job Awarded, payment `pending_manual_payout` until admin pays by hand.
- Self-award (same account as creator + musician) blocked.

Can producers extend the deadline? Not today. Edit job only changes title, description, reference tracks, and tempo — not price, not deadline. Extending deadline would be a product add (and needs a rule for “already past deadline”).

If they’re not happy with takes? Before award: Cancel & refund (full), or wait out the 48h window with no favorite → auto refund. They cannot end the gig early to stop submissions. After Awarded: no self-serve “undo” — would be support/admin.

7. What musicians see

- Only **Open** jobs on the board (Drafts are invisible).
- Submit free; one submission per job (up to 3 takes inside).
- Paid only if awarded. Previews available while open; full masters after award for the winner.

8. Payment methods (Checkout)

Stripe Embedded Checkout shows whatever is enabled on the Stripe account: card, Link, Apple Pay, Cash App, Affirm, Klarna, bank, etc. Returning users who used Link before may land on Link first (cookies) — first-time users still get the full method list. Branding colors/logo: Stripe Dashboard → Settings → Branding.

9. Gaps / meeting agenda (edit freely)

1. Deadline extend — add or not?

2. Cancel/refund fee policy (who eats Stripe's cut)?
3. Preview policy (full MP3 vs clip) once charging up front.
4. Community email: thank early users; explain pay-upfront; no more 7-day card holds.
5. Musician email shared with producer on award (still TODO).

Source of truth in code: `app/api/jobs/*`, `lib/jobActions.ts`, `lib/checkoutActivate.ts`, `app/api/cron/jobs`, `app/api/webhooks/stripe`.

Companion: `docs/damian-2026-09-20/CHARGE-UPFRONT-PLAN.pdf`